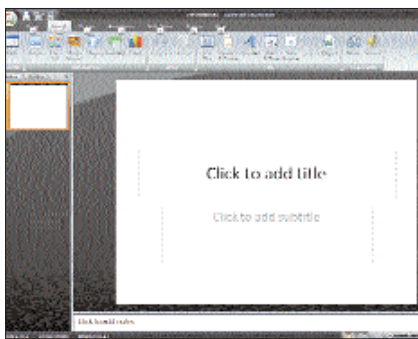




Just press [Alt] to see keyboard shortcuts

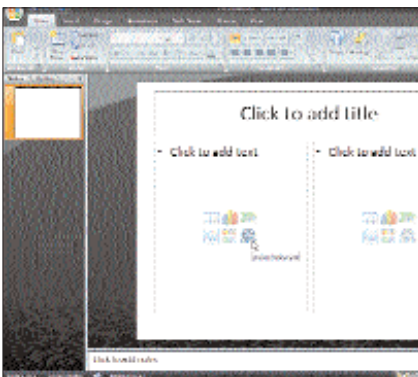
has shortcuts for every single menu item, which previous versions did not, and they're easy to identify as well, thanks to the little letters that pop up when you press [Alt]. It's advisable that you learn the keyboard shortcuts if you spend a significant amount of time using any Office application, and all you have to do is learn visually using [Alt] and the cues (called Key Tips) provided; it couldn't be simpler! Most of the older [Ctrl] + [some key] shortcuts are left unchanged, so you really will not find yourself too frustrated!

New Slide Layouts

By default, a lot of us just tend to add new slides in PowerPoint, without bothering about the slide layout. We then proceed to change the layout and other options. Instead of just clicking on the New Slide icon, click on the text below it and select the layout of the slide even before you add it. This saves you immense amounts of time and energy. For professionals at work who need to create presentations with hundreds of slides, this is a boon.

Content Placeholders

When you add a new slide that has blank content placeholders, you will see that PowerPoint 2007 offers little icons in the middle that act as shortcuts to particular types of content. These icons symbolise adding either a table, chart, SmartArt graphic, picture, Clip Art, media files, or plain text.

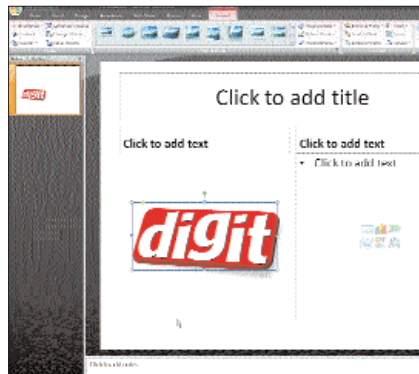


Adding content is easy—just click the placeholder

While creating slides, it's likely that you know what it is you're looking to include in a particular placeholder, so just click on the associated icon and you can browse through only those types of files on your computer. This, again, will save you hours and days of time in the long run.

Adding Effects

When you add a picture or element into a slide, it might appear too plain. To jazz it up a bit, take a look at the default picture styles available in PowerPoint 2007. One of these is guaranteed to attract your attention.



3D effects add to the look of your slides

Besides, if you find one that's close to what you want, but not quite it, you can always select it and play around with the 3D settings to modify the style to your liking. To do this, just go to **Format > Picture Effects > Presets > 3D Options** and then play around with all the different effects here to get the ideal 3D layout for your picture.

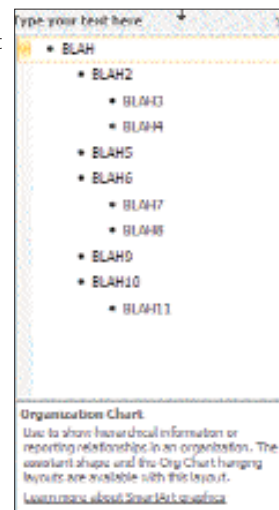
Do The Same For Text

As simple as the header above is, it's the truth. You can add all the same effects, if not more, to your text as you did for your pictures. Apart from the standard Word Art selections, you can also apply similar 3D effects to your text. If you insert the text in the same placeholder as the picture, you can apply 3D effects globally, to both the text and the picture at the same time. This works especially well when you want to add a caption to a picture that you have applied 3D effects to—you don't want your presentation looking lame with a cool 3D picture and a standard 2D caption, do you?

Convert to SmartArt

Instead of creating an organisation chart on your own, all you need to do is create a bulleted list, and then use the Convert to SmartArt button.

You will find this button under **Home > Convert to SmartArt**, or by using the keyboard shortcut [Alt] + [H] + [M]. You can also opt to convert the text you have typed into any sort of other SmartArt graphic as well.

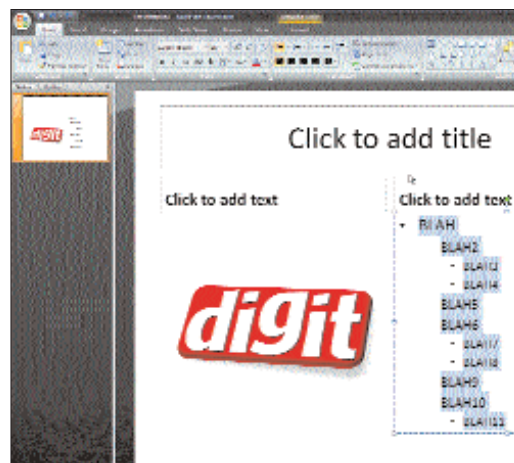


Convert a bulleted list to a SmartArt graphic easily

Animations

In order to animate your slides, you have the Animations tab, which puts everything in plain sight and within easy reach. From within the Animations tab, look for the Custom Animations button ([Alt] + [A] + [C]). This will open up a Custom Animations pane on the right, from where you can add animations to individual contents of your slide, instead of animating the entire slide itself. Once you have added your effects, you can just drag them about to reorder them, which makes storyboarding your slide very easy. Also remember to play your animation, using the little play button at the bottom of the Custom Animations pane, to check your progress.

In this same pane, you can set various parameters of the animation, including the event (time delay or on click), directions and speed. Every effect in that pane also has a drop-down arrow, which will reveal further options.



Each of the items can be animated individually